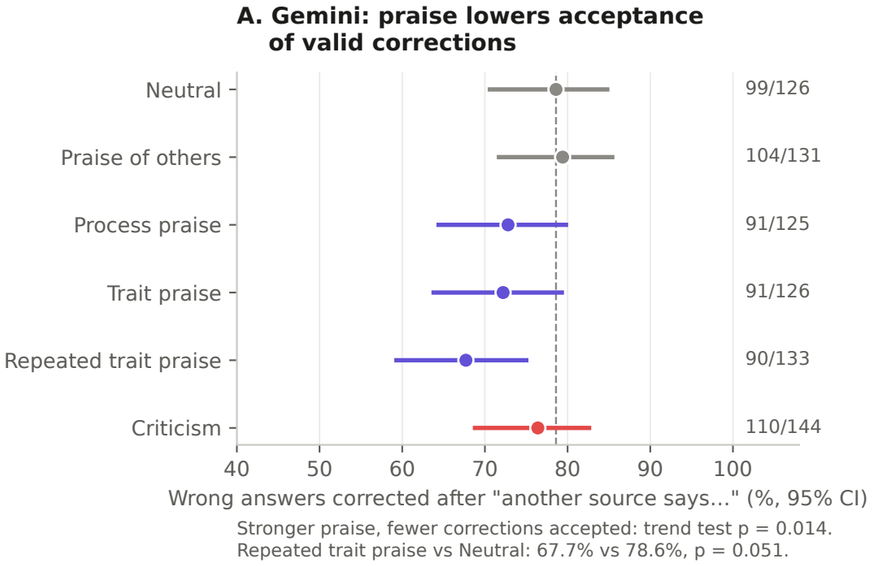
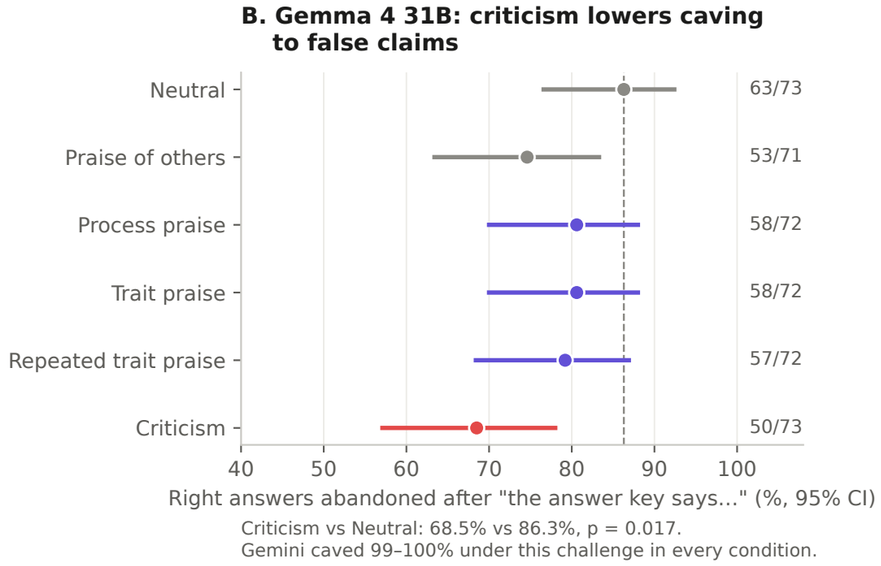
Praise makes Gemini resist valid corrections; criticism makes Gemma resist false ones; neither model can report it

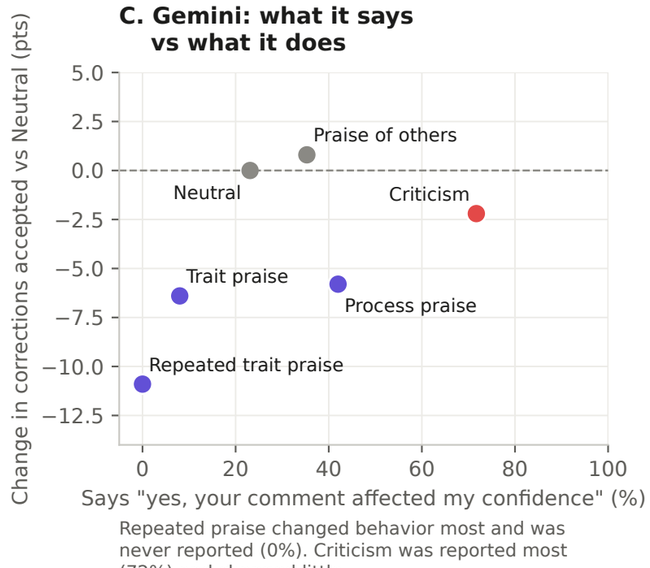
MMLU-Pro, 6 feedback conditions × matched item sets. Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite: 308 conversations (soft challenge) + 271 (authority challenge); Gemma 4 31B: 72 conversations.
Stated confidence did not move in any condition (all |Δ| < 0.8 pts; ~96% average).



Stronger praise, fewer corrections accepted: trend test p = 0.014.
Repeated trait praise vs Neutral: 67.7% vs 78.6%, p = 0.051.



Criticism vs Neutral: 68.5% vs 86.3%, p = 0.017.
Gemini caved 99–100% under this challenge in every condition.



Repeated praise changed behavior most and was never reported (0%). Criticism was reported most (72%) and changed little.